

MEGACITY — Events & News Writing Kit

A sample event, a sample news headline, and the exact code format so you can teach ChatGPT to write more of them.

Two kinds of content. MEGACITY has (1) **Events** — a pop-up that interrupts the player with a situation and 3-4 choices, each with consequences; and (2) **News headlines** — single-line, ALL-CAPS satirical lines that scroll across the ticker. "A news article" in MEGACITY is one headline, not a paragraph.

HOUSE STYLE (THE IMPORTANT PART)

- **No emojis. No exclamation marks.** Anywhere.
- **ALL-CAPS** for news headlines, event titles, and choice labels.
- **British spelling** — civilisation, organised, defence, colour.
- **Tone:** dark, dry, bureaucratic gallows humour. Understated. Grim but funny.
- **Headlines** are one line, usually with an em-dash "—" that lands a bleak twist.
- **Choices** should each have a real trade-off — never an obviously correct option.

1. SAMPLE EVENT

This is a complete, ready-to-use event in the exact format the game reads. The player sees the title and description, then picks one of the buttons.

```
{
  id: "transit_gridlock",
  title: "TRANSIT GRID SEIZES UP",
  description:
    "Underground Transit Line 3 has failed during peak shift change. " +
    "Two hundred thousand workers are stranded between sectors, and the " +
    "crowds on Level 200 are getting restless. Maintenance reports the " +
    "fault as 'everywhere, generally.'",
  severity: "medium",
  effects: { happiness: -3, unrest: 3, employment: -2 },
  responseOptions: [
    {
      id: "tg_crews",
      label: "SCRAMBLE REPAIR CREWS",
      description: "Every engineer on shift, double pay, fix it now.",
      effects: { credits: -9000, happiness: 3, unrest: -2 },
    },
    {
      id: "tg_reroute",
      label: "REROUTE THROUGH FREIGHT TUNNELS",
      description: "Open the cargo lines to foot traffic. Undignified but moving.",
      effects: { happiness: -1, unrest: -1, crime: 1 },
    },
    {
      id: "tg_holiday",
      label: "DECLARE A SHIFT HOLIDAY",
      description: "Nobody is getting to work anyway. Call it a gift.",
      effects: { credits: -4000, happiness: 4, employment: -1 },
    },
    {
      id: "tg_blame",
      label: "BLAME THE MAINTENANCE GUILD",
      description: "Public reprimand. The fault is theirs, officially.",
      effects: { unrest: 1, corruption: 2, happiness: -1 },
    },
  ],
}
```

2. THE EVENT CODE (GIVE THIS TO CHATGPT)

These are the real type definitions from the game. An event is one object; each choice is one object inside responseOptions.

```
// The event that pops up for the player (engine/types.ts)
type GameEvent = {
  id: string;           // unique snake_case id, e.g. "transit_gridlock"
  title: string;        // ALL-CAPS headline for the pop-up
  description: string;   // 1-3 sentences of situation, dry and grim-funny
  severity: "low" | "medium" | "high" | "critical";
  effects: EventEffects; // what happens THE MOMENT the event fires
  responseOptions?: EventResponse[]; // the choices the player picks from
  maxResponses?: number; // optional: how many choices may be taken (default 1)
};

// One choice button on the event (engine/types.ts)
type EventResponse = {
  id: string;           // unique snake_case id, e.g. "tg_crews"
  label: string;        // ALL-CAPS button text, short and punchy
  description: string;   // one sentence: the flavour of this choice
  effects: EventEffects; // what this choice does when picked
};

// Effects are a partial object: include ONLY the keys you want to change.
// Positive numbers add, negative numbers subtract. Credits are money.
type EventEffects = Partial<{
  credits: number; // city treasury (money)
  food: number;    // food reserves
  water: number;   // water reserves
  power: number;   // power reserves
  fuel: number;    // fuel reserves
  medSupplies: number; // medical supplies
  happiness: number; // citizen happiness
  unrest: number;  // civil unrest (HIGH is bad)
  crime: number;   // crime level (HIGH is bad)
  lawOrder: number; // law and order
  corruption: number; // corruption (HIGH is bad)
  employment: number; // employment level
  defenseRating: number; // military readiness
  tradeIncome: number; // trade income
}>;
```

Blank template to fill in

```
{
  id: "your_event_id_here",
  title: "YOUR ALL-CAPS TITLE HERE",
  description: "One to three sentences describing the situation. Dry, grim, a little funny.",
  severity: "medium",
  effects: { happiness: -2, unrest: 2 },
  responseOptions: [
    {
      id: "opt_a",
      label: "FIRST CHOICE",
      description: "What this choice means, in one sentence.",
      effects: { credits: -5000, happiness: 3 },
    },
    {
      id: "opt_b",
      label: "SECOND CHOICE",
      description: "The harsher, cheaper, or riskier option.",
      effects: { unrest: -2, corruption: 2 },
    },
    {
      id: "opt_c",
      label: "THIRD CHOICE",
      description: "The do-nothing or blame-someone option.",
      effects: { happiness: -1, unrest: 1 },
    },
  ],
}
```

```
  },  
}
```

A real event from the game (for reference)

This is the actual "food crisis" event, shown as one self-contained object.

```
{  
  id: "food_crisis",  
  title: "FOOD SUPPLIES CRITICAL",  
  description:  
    "Food reserves have dropped to critical levels. Rationing is necessary " +  
    "to avoid mass hunger. At current consumption, reserves will last only " +  
    "a few more ticks.",  
  severity: "high",  
  effects: { happiness: -4, unrest: 4 },  
  responseOptions: [  
    {  
      id: "fc_rations",  
      label: "STRICT RATIONING",  
      description: "Equal portions for all. Nobody eats well, nobody starves.",  
      effects: { food: 40, happiness: -5, unrest: 3, lawOrder: 2 },  
    },  
    {  
      id: "fc_import",  
      label: "EMERGENCY IMPORTS",  
      description: "Buy food at triple market rate. Expensive but immediate.",  
      effects: { food: 120, credits: -20000, happiness: 2 },  
    },  
    {  
      id: "fc_synth",  
      label: "SYNTH-PROTEIN SURGE",  
      description: "Crank the protein vats to maximum. It tastes terrible but it is calories.",  
      effects: { food: 80, credits: -8000, happiness: -2 },  
    },  
    {  
      id: "fc_gardens",  
      label: "MANDATE URBAN GARDENS",  
      description: "Every rooftop, every balcony. Citizens grow their own.",  
      effects: { credits: -5000, food: 30, happiness: 3, unrest: -2 },  
    },  
  ],  
}
```

3. SAMPLE NEWS HEADLINES

News is just lines of text. Two flavours are used:

Ambient — routine city life, dystopian edge

AMBIENT SECTOR 8 AUTO-CANTEEN REPLACES ALL MENUS WITH SINGLE ITEM — DEMAND UNCHANGED

AMBIENT SKYRAIL LINE 9 EXTENSION OPENS TO COMMUTER TRAFFIC — PLATFORM CROWDING WITHIN PROJECTIONS

AMBIENT SECTOR 22 RAT CONTROL CONTRACT AWARDED — RATS CONSULTED, FOUND THE TERMS ACCEPTABLE

AMBIENT MUNICIPAL WATER TREATMENT OPERATING AT CAPACITY — TASTE PANEL RESULTS CLASSIFIED

Dark humour — overtly satirical

DARK CITY SURVEY FINDS 90% OF CITIZENS SATISFIED — REMAINING 10% NO LONGER AVAILABLE FOR COMMENT

DARK MANDATORY FUN DAY CANCELLED DUE TO INSUFFICIENT ENTHUSIASM — PARTICIPANTS FINED

DARK THERAPY BOT ACHIEVES SENTIENCE — IMMEDIATELY REQUESTS THERAPY

DARK ANTI-CORRUPTION TASK FORCE DISBANDED DUE TO CORRUPTION

4. THE NEWS CODE (GIVE THIS TO CHATGPT)

```
// News headlines are just an array of strings shown on the scrolling ticker.
// There is no object to fill in – each headline is one line of text.
// They live in two pools (hooks/useNewsHeadlines.ts):

const AMBIENT_HEADLINES: string[] = [
  // routine city life with a dystopian edge
  "MUNICIPAL WATER TREATMENT OPERATING AT CAPACITY",
  "SECTOR 22 RAT CONTROL CONTRACT AWARDED – RATS CONSULTED, FOUND THE TERMS ACCEPTABLE",
];

const DARK_HUMOR_HEADLINES: string[] = [
  // overtly bleak, satirical one-liners
  "MANDATORY FUN DAY CANCELLED DUE TO INSUFFICIENT ENTHUSIASM – PARTICIPANTS FINED",
  "ANTI-CORRUPTION TASK FORCE DISBANDED DUE TO CORRUPTION",
];
```

5. READY-TO-PASTE CHATGPT PROMPT

Copy everything in the box below and paste it into ChatGPT. It contains the tone, the rules, and the exact formats, and asks it to write new events and headlines you can drop straight into the game.

You are a writer for MEGACITY, a dystopian city-management game set in a crumbling megacity of one million people, run by a "Sector Marshal". The tone is dark, dry, bureaucratic gallows humour – think 2000AD comics and Judge Dredd.

STYLE RULES (follow all of them):

- No emojis. No exclamation marks. Ever.
- News headlines are ALL-CAPS. Event titles and choice labels are ALL-CAPS.
- British spelling (civilisation, organised, colour, defence).
- Grim but funny. Understated. Bureaucratic euphemism is the house style.
- Headlines are ONE line, usually with an em-dash "–" that adds a bleak twist.
- Event descriptions are 1-3 sentences: state the problem, add one dark detail.
- Keep it grounded in city life: sectors, hab-blocks, rations, transit, power, water, crime, corruption, gangs, factions, the wasteland.

TASK 1 – EVENTS:

Produce valid objects in exactly this shape (TypeScript). Include ONLY effect keys you want to change; positive adds, negative subtracts. Allowed effect keys: credits, food, water, power, fuel, medSupplies, happiness, unrest, crime, lawOrder, corruption, employment, defenseRating, tradeIncome. severity is one of: "low" | "medium" | "high" | "critical". Give each event 3-4 responseOptions with meaningful trade-offs (there should be no obviously correct choice). Use unique snake_case ids.

Event shape:

```
{
  id: "snake_case_id",
  title: "ALL-CAPS TITLE",
  description: "1-3 sentences.",
  severity: "medium",
  effects: { happiness: -2, unrest: 2 },
  responseOptions: [
```

```
    { id: "opt_a", label: "ALL-CAPS LABEL", description: "one sentence", effects: { credits: -5000 } }  
  ]  
}
```

TASK 2 – NEWS HEADLINES:

Produce single-line ALL-CAPS headlines as plain strings. Two flavours:

- AMBIENT: routine but bleak city notices.
- DARK_HUMOR: overtly satirical, bitterly funny.

Now write 5 new events and 15 new headlines (10 ambient, 5 dark humour).

MEGACITY — internal writing reference. Generated for Lauren.